

Module 05: Action — Taking Turns

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Action** in a game means waiting for your turn.
2. Learn about **Inhibition** (Stopping your body from moving).
3. Know that taking turns makes the game fair and fun for everyone.

Introduction: The Stop Sign

In a car, you have a Gas Pedal (Go) and a Brake Pedal (Stop). In your brain, you have them too!

- **Go** = "I want the ball NOW!"
- **Stop** = "Wait. It is not my turn." Using the Brake Pedal is the hardest part of being a player.

Key Concepts

1. Inhibition (The Brain Brake)

It takes more brain power to STOP moving than to START moving. When you wait for your turn, your brain is working hard! It is saying "Don't grab it! Don't grab it!" This is called **Impulse Control**.

2. The Sequence (My Turn, Your Turn)

Games are a conversation. If everyone talks at once -> Noise. If everyone moves at once -> Crash. The Action Loop: Wait -> Perceive -> Act -> Wait.

3. Fairness (Sharing Time)

If one person takes all the turns, is it a game? No, it's a show. Fairness means sharing the resource of **Time**.

Activities

Activity 1: The Talking Stick

Find a stick (or a spoon). Only the person holding the stick can speak. Pass it around the dinner table. Did you interrupt? Did you want to? That feeling of "I want to talk!" is your **Gas Pedal**. The waiting is your **Brake Pedal**.

Activity 2: Red Light, Green Light

This is the ultimate Impulse Control game. Run fast (Action). STOP! (Inhibition). If you move when you should stop, your Brake Pedal failed. Practice makes the brakes stronger!

Summary

Action isn't just about moving. It's about moving at the *right time*. Waiting your turn is the mark of a pro.

References

- *Llama Llama Time to Share* by Anna Dewdney
- *Waiting Is Not Easy!* (Elephant and Piggie) by Mo Willems